

ARKHAM HORROR[®]

THE CARD GAME

The Still Hour Campaign Guide

A campaign for 1–4 investigators, best with 3.

How to Use This Guide

This guide is read as you play. **Do not read ahead.** It tells you when to read each section: the Prologue first, then the loop, then the districts as you reach them. Story text in boxes is read aloud. Everything after a "**Do not read until...**" line stays unread until the guide sends you there.

The Still Hour is not a line of separate scenarios. It is **one night, lived over and over**. You will play the Prologue once, then play the night again and again (each play-through is a **loop**), learning a little more of it each time, until you know enough to end it. Every loop costs you years.

Along the way the guide will ask you to **make choices**. Record each one in your Campaign Log. Nothing you choose in Ambergrove stays where you left it: every choice returns somewhere else in the town, and all of them return at the end.

Campaign Rules

These rules add to the Arkham Horror: The Card Game Rules Reference. Where they disagree with it, these rules win. Numbers are for **three investigators**; **Difficulty and Player Count** gives the other values, and the Control token applies them for you.

Loops. A loop is one play of the night, from Loop Setup until the loop ends. A loop ends at once when the Hourglass reaches **Hour IX**, when every investigator has been defeated, or when Dissonance reaches the **reset value** (18). For card text, "scenario" and "game" mean the current loop, and "interlude" means **Between Loops**. The Prologue is not a loop.

Limits. "Limit once per loop" and "Max once per loop" last until the loop ends. As in the Rules Reference, a limit applies to each investigator separately unless it says "group limit", and "Max" counts every copy of that card, for all investigators.

The reset. When a loop ends, read its resolutions, then **Between Loops**. The board is cleared: every card the boxes laid out, and every token on those cards, leaves the table, and every **[static]** token leaves the chaos bag. The Hourglass returns to Hour I, the Appointed returns to Unseen, and Dissonance restarts at the **scar**: the number of loops completed so far, maximum 6 at three investigators (see **Difficulty and Player Count**). Banked Memory, the Campaign Log and Years carry forward. Within a loop nothing resets: damage, horror, resources and cards in play stay as they are when you travel between districts.

Defeat. Investigators do not suffer trauma in The Still Hour and are never killed. A defeated investigator is eliminated for the rest of the loop, as the Rules Reference describes; Memory on their cards is still banked at the reset. Defeat costs Years instead (see **Years**). An investigator leaves the campaign only by aging out, or in the finale.

Parts of the campaign. The campaign has three parts. They are not act cards.

- **Part I — Learning the Rules.** Only each district's first objective (act 1a) can be completed.
- **Part II — The Shape of the Hour.** It begins at **Between Loops** step 5. Each district's second objective (act 2a) opens, the Appointed's Whispers join the encounter deck, and the Named enter the night.
- **The Last Hour.** The finale, once your Campaign Log records **The Way the Night Breaks**.

The Hourglass. The Hours (I–IX) are the agenda deck: "the Hourglass" is that deck, and the current Hour is the current agenda. Hours I–VIII have a doom threshold of 1, so from the second round on the Hourglass advances 1 Hour in each Mythos phase (step 1.3).

- **Advance the Hourglass by X Hours** (a **Skip**) advances the agenda at once, one Hour at a time: remove all doom in play, turn the current Hour over and read its back, then make the next Hour the current agenda. Set each advanced Hour aside, in order, beside the Hours deck instead of removing it from the game. The Hourglass never advances past Hour IX. Any effect that advances the Hourglass is a Skip.
- **When reached.** Each time an Hour becomes the current agenda by advancing (by doom or by a Skip), resolve its "When reached" text. A Skip of several Hours resolves each Hour in order. If the Hourglass reaches an Hour again after a rewind, its text resolves again.
- **Rewind the Hourglass by X Hours:** X times, put the current Hour back on top of the Hours deck and make the last Hour you set aside the current agenda again, with no doom on it. Rewinding never resolves "When reached" text and does not end effects an Hour already created. The Hourglass never rewinds before Hour I. An Hour removed from the Hours deck is stepped over in both directions.
- **Cancel an advance:** cancel all of it, however many Hours it would advance. The current Hour stays current; remove all doom from it.

Districts and travel. Ambergrove has six **districts**; each is a cluster of locations laid out from its own box, and every location

belongs to one district. **The Square** is the hub. The district connections are The Square–The Nave, The Square–The Milestones, The Square–The Ticket Booth, The Square–The Reading Room and The Turning–The Winding Stair. The first time in a round that any investigator moves along a given district connection (in either direction, by any means), advance the Hourglass by 1 Hour after that move. Other investigators may move along that same connection later in the round without advancing it. A move that is not along a connection, or that says it does not advance the Hourglass, costs no Hours. Enemy moves never cost Hours. You will reach only two or three districts before time runs out.

Dissonance. A shared value from 0 to the reset value (18). It changes only when an effect says to **raise** or **lower** it. Dissonance sets the band:

Band	Dissonance	While in this band	On entering this band
Calm	0–5	No [static] token in the chaos bag. Echoes are Sleepwalking.	—
Glitch	6–11	1 [static] token in the chaos bag.	The Appointed's Approach advances to at least Sensed.
Noticed	12–17	2 [static] tokens in the chaos bag.	The Appointed's Approach advances to Arrived.
Reset	18	—	The loop ends at once, even during a skill test or the finale.

A band change takes effect at once. **[static]** tokens added by cards are in addition to the band's. Lowering Dissonance never pushes the Approach back. Setting Dissonance at Loop Setup does not count as entering a band.

[static]. A chaos token and a symbol token (cards call it the Static token): **–3. Raise Dissonance by 1.** Like the other symbol effects, this resolves when the token is revealed during a skill test; the token returns to the bag afterwards. A canceled **[static]** token has no modifier and no effect. A sealed **[static]** token still counts toward its band's number.

Echoes and Sleepwalking. An Echo is an enemy with the Echo trait. **Sleepwalking** is a keyword: while an enemy is Sleepwalking, it cannot engage or be engaged, attack, or move, and it cannot be attacked, evaded, dealt damage or chosen as the target of a card ability. It is still an enemy in play at its location. A Sleepwalking enemy that would spawn engaged with an investigator spawns unengaged at that investigator's location instead; an engaged enemy that becomes Sleepwalking disengages and stays where it is. An Echo is Sleepwalking only while Dissonance is in the Calm band, unless a card says otherwise. It **wakes** when it stops being Sleepwalking, and it can fall asleep again.

The Appointed. Something called the Appointed climbs an **Approach**: Unseen, Sensed, Emerging, Arrived. To **advance** the Approach (to a stage) means to raise it, never lower it; to **push it back** means to lower it by one stage, never below Unseen. When the Approach becomes Sensed or later while the Appointed is set aside, it **manifests**: put it into play at the revealed location farthest from all investigators that is not closed (the lead investigator

breaks ties). When it is pushed back to Unseen, set it aside. It cannot be defeated. **Hold Back** is an  on its card that only an investigator at its location can take. A "Hold Back success" means succeeding at its test, or resolving it without a test when a card allows. Its behaviour at each stage is on **The Appointed's Approach**, which is in play beside the Hours deck during every loop and the finale.

Memory.

- **Memory on cards** is Memory tokens on investigator and asset cards you control. "Most Memory" in a prey or spawn instruction means Memory on cards. Uses on Borrowed Time are not Memory.
- **Banked Memory** is one pool the whole party shares. "Each investigator gains X banked Memory" adds X to the pool per investigator.
- At the reset, all Memory on cards (including the cards of defeated investigators) is banked. Between loops you spend banked Memory as experience (Rules Reference, "Experience"), except: a Recollection costs its printed Memory cost; upgrading a card costs Memory equal to the new card's level (not the difference); a new level 0 card costs 1. After spending, if banked Memory is above 18, reduce it to 18.
- Recollections are not part of a starting deck; they are bought between loops. Signature Recollections are the exception.

Knowledge. Completing a district's objectives records **Knowledge** entries in your Campaign Log. An entry belongs to the whole party and changes the night from then on; its lasting effect is printed on the Campaign Log beside it. Entries from acts 1a are **surface** entries; entries from acts 2a are **deep** entries. Knowledge is never bought, only found. "Your Campaign Log records X" means X is written on the log; "you completed <act> this loop" means that act advanced during the loop.

- **Assembled entries.** One entry is assembled from others rather than found: the act that can first complete it says what it needs. From then on, each time you record a deep entry, check it again. The Control token does this for you and tells you when to record it.

Years. At each reset, each investigator gains **Years**: 1 always; 1 more if they were defeated during the loop; 1 more if the loop ended in the Noticed band or higher (12+); and 1 more if they **leaned on the loop** (during the loop, they paid "raise Dissonance" as a cost 3 or more times, or removed 4 or more Memory from their own cards to pay for their own cards and abilities). Years that a card or resolution gives (A Year in a Night, the ninth line, the name) are recorded when gained with the **Years pending** button on that investigator's card, and added at Between Loops step 1 with the reset Years. Years set an investigator's age bracket, and a higher bracket replaces the lower. Bracket changes apply only Between Loops. Skills and maximum health and sanity never drop below 1.

- **Prime (0–4 Years):** no change.
- **Weathered (5–9):** the first time an investigator reaches Weathered or a later bracket, choose and record **–1**  or **–1** , and **+1**  or **+1** . These choices are locked.
- **Elder (10–14):** the Weathered changes, **+1** more to the same mental skill, **–1** maximum health, and they begin each loop with 1 Memory on their investigator card.
- **Ancient (15+):** the Elder changes and **–1** maximum sanity.

- An investigator who reaches **18 Years** ages out of the campaign at the next Between Loops. Their player may begin the next loop with a new investigator not yet used in this campaign (0 Years, new deck), or the party continues without them: set **Investigators** on the Control token to the new number.

For finale conditions and the epilogue, an investigator's bracket is set by all their Years, including Years gained during that loop and the finale.

Victory. Each **Victory X** pays once per campaign. When you defeat a **Named** enemy (an Elite with Victory X, which from Part II some districts add), or when a loop ends with a Victory X location in play, revealed and with no clues on it: if its name is not on your Campaign Log's Victory list, record it and add X to banked Memory (X in total, not per investigator). A Named enemy can be met again in a later loop, but only the first defeat pays.

Closed and impassable locations. A **closed** location has no clues and is not connected to anything: investigators and enemies cannot move into it, and nothing spawns or manifests there. When it opens, it is revealed: place its clues on it. (The Rules Reference's "seal" is only for chaos tokens; the location called The Sealed Study keeps its name.) Investigators and enemies cannot move into an **impassable** location; anything already there stays unless it is told to move.

The Control token. The Control token keeps the campaign's books. Use it like this, and do not also apply by hand what it applies for you:

- **Hour.** Each time the Hourglass advances or rewinds, move the Hours deck to match and click **Hour** once per Hour (left-click advance, right-click rewind). On an advance it applies Hour III's base +1 Dissonance, the Approach at Hours V, VII and VIII, Hour VI's **[static]** token and Hour VIII's +2 Dissonance. Resolve the rest yourself: Hour II's encounter draws, Hour III's extra +1 at a Church location (click Dissonance), Hour IV, Hour VII's exhaust, Hour VIII's +1 fight and Hour IX.
- **Dissonance.** Each time a card or ability raises or lowers Dissonance, click **Dissonance** (left-click +1, right-click -1). It adds and removes the band's **[static]** tokens and advances the Approach when a band is entered. Exception: when a **[static]** token is drawn from the chaos bag, the Control token raises Dissonance by 1 itself; do not click for it. If that token is then canceled, or was revealed outside a skill test, right-click **Dissonance** once.
- **Temporary Static tokens.** When a card adds a Static token for a limited time, left-click **[static]**; when that time ends, right-click it. (Hour VI's token is applied by **Hour**.)
- **Leaning on the loop.** Each time an investigator pays "raise Dissonance" as a cost or additional cost, click **Dissonance raised** on their investigator card (as well as **Dissonance**). Each time they remove Memory from their own cards to pay for, or by choosing to on, one of their own cards or abilities (for example Foreknowledge), click **Loop-power Memory** once per Memory. The Interlude's **Age** button reads these.
- **Years pending.** When a card or resolution gives an investigator Years, click **Years pending** on their investigator card; **Age** adds them.
- **Memory on cards.** Click an investigator's **Memory** row when Memory is placed on or removed from their cards (left-click +1, right-click -1).

- **The Appointed.** When The Crossing, The Debt of Hours or the finale advances the Approach, click **Appointed** once per stage. On its card, click **Hold Back** only after a Hold Back success (disengage and exhaust the card yourself), and, while it hunts, click **Hunt** once in each enemy phase while it is ready and unengaged. If the Control token places it on a closed, unrevealed or impassable location, move it to the location the rules require.
- **Knowledge and Victory.** When you record a Knowledge entry or a Victory, tick it on the Campaign Log token. The Control token records it too: it turns the locations a Knowledge entry changes and banks a Victory's Memory the first time only.
- **Contest.** In the finale, the Control token shows a **Contest** counter (left-click +1, right-click -1).
- **Aging.** In the Interlude panel, set each investigator's **Defeated** toggle, and the first time they reach Weathered, their -skill and +skill buttons, before clicking **Age**.
- **Memory. Begin Next Loop** already places the 1 Memory an Elder or Ancient investigator begins with. Click the banked **Memory** button when banked Memory changes outside the Interlude panel (the Prologue's rewards, The House Always Wins, Resolution 1b).
- **Between loops.** Use **Reset Loop**, **Interlude**, **Begin Next Loop** and **Clear Board** as **Between Loops** and **Loop Setup** direct.

Campaign Setup

1. **Choose investigators.** The campaign is tuned for 3; it scales from 1 to 4.
2. **Build decks.** Each investigator builds a deck under their deckbuilding rules, adding 1 random basic weakness as normal.
3. **Choose a difficulty** and assemble the chaos bag. On the Control token, click your difficulty's button (**Easy**, **Standard**, **Hard** or **Expert**): it fills SCED's chaos bag with the tokens below. Without SCED, build the bag by hand. Then set **Investigators** on the Control token to the number of investigators.

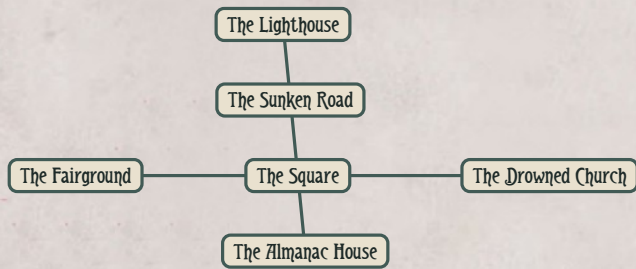
Difficulty	Chaos tokens
Easy	+1, +1, 0, 0, 0, -1, -1, -1, -2, -2,
Standard	+1, 0, 0, -1, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -4,
Hard	0, 0, 0, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -3, -4, -5,
Expert	0, -1, -1, -2, -2, -3, -3, -4, -4, -5, -6, -8,

Use the scenario reference card's Easy / Standard side for Easy and Standard, and its Hard / Expert side for Hard and Expert.

4. **Take the Campaign Log** (the log token, or the pages at the back of this guide). Record your investigators and difficulty. The log keeps what you have not yet learned hidden: each Knowledge entry, Named enemy and choice has a row, and its name appears on the token only when you tick it (on the printed pages, write it on the row's line). Each investigator starts at **0 Years**; banked Memory (one shared pool) starts at **0**.
5. Turn to **Prologue — The First Hour**.

The Ambergrove Map

A small inland town under a starless, snagged sky. **The Square** is the hub. The first move each round along a connection between two districts advances the Hourglass by 1 Hour (see **Districts and travel**).



- **The Square** connects to the Fairground, the Drowned Church, the Almanac House and the Sunken Road.
- **The Sunken Road** connects the Square to the **Lighthouse**.
- Each district is a cluster of 2–4 locations. They enter play unrevealed unless their entry says otherwise. As the Rules Reference describes, when an investigator enters an unrevealed location, it is revealed: flip it, and SCED places its clues.

Prologue – The First Hour

You came to Ambergrove for your own reasons: a letter, a debt, a promise, a rumour. You will not remember them, soon.

Ambergrove is a town on no one's way to anywhere: a church, a road out to the shore, a lighthouse no ship has needed in years, a printing house that sells almanacs to three counties. Tonight it is full. The almanac has promised an occultation, a star swallowed by the dark of something passing in front of it, once in a hundred years, and visible from here and nowhere else.

The whole town has turned out for the occultation. Lanterns are strung across the Square. A band is tuning up by the Town Hall steps, and children ride their fathers' shoulders, pointing at a sky that is not quite right.

The almanac promised the occultation at midnight. It is eleven, and the stars are already sliding behind something that has no edge. You will remember everything else.

Setup

1. Press **Place** on **The First Hour** box. It lays out:
 - the **Hours** as the agenda deck, Hour I on top;
 - the act **The First Hour**;
 - **The Still Hour** scenario reference card;
 - the encounter deck, face down. Shuffle it;
 - the story card **The First Reset**, set aside. Read it when the Prologue ends.
2. Put **The Square**, **The Long Pier** and **The Almanac Steps** into play in a row (Place does this). The Square is revealed; the other two are unrevealed. Each investigator begins at **The Square**.
3. The Control token starts a new campaign in the Prologue, at **Hour I** with Dissonance **0**. The chaos bag is in the Calm band.
4. Each investigator takes 5 resources and draws an opening hand of 5 cards (mulligan as normal). You are ready to begin.

There is no Appointed in the Prologue, and no Years are gained in it: ignore any text that refers to the Appointed, and A Year in a Night gives no Year.

Note. The Prologue teaches the loop. It cannot be lost: however it ends, the night resets, and how well you did decides one small reward.

Do not read until the end of the scenario.

Resolution 1 – You Saw It Coming (you advanced The First Hour)

You were standing on the right step at the right second. You watched the occultation complete, and you watched something reach through, and not finish reaching. When the night folds, you fold with it on purpose, and you keep more of it.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory**, and the party gains **1** more banked Memory.
- In your Campaign Log, record **You Are Unstuck**. Part I begins.
- No Years are gained from the Prologue.
- Read **What You Saw**, below.

Resolution 2 – It Caught You Unready (the Hourglass reached Hour IX, or Dissonance reached the reset value)

The occultation completes. Something reaches through, and does not finish reaching. The night folds. You are standing in the Square again at eleven o'clock, salt on your tongue, and you are the only ones who feel the seam.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory**.
- In your Campaign Log, record **You Are Unstuck**. Part I begins.
- No Years are gained from the Prologue.
- Read **What You Saw**, below.

No Resolution – The First Death (every investigator was defeated)

The last thing you see is the sky finishing what it started: the final star sliding behind the edgeless dark. There is no pain. There is a long, patient silence, like a held breath. Then a band is tuning up, and the lanterns are being lit, and it is eleven o'clock. You remember dying. You remember all of it.

- Each investigator gains **2 banked Memory**.
- In your Campaign Log, record **You Are Unstuck**. Part I begins.
- No Years are gained from the Prologue. This first death is free. None of the others will be.
- Read **What You Saw**, below.

What You Saw

Salt on your tongue. The same lanterns, the same band, the same children on the same shoulders. You look at one another across the Square and see it in each other's faces: you all remember. No one else does. A woman in a green shawl asks if you are feeling well.

The investigators must decide (choose one):

- **Tell the town.** Stand on the Town Hall steps and tell them what is coming, though they will not believe a word. Record in your Campaign Log: *The town was warned.* (on the log token:

this row's **1st** box.)

- **Tell no one.** Whatever this is, it is yours to carry, and a secret kept is a card still in the hand. Record in your Campaign Log: *You kept the night to yourselves.* (on the log token: this row's **2nd** box.)

Then, on the Control token, click **Reset Loop**. This ends the Prologue; the Prologue does not count as a loop. Turn to **The Loop**, read **Between Loops**, and begin Loop 1.

The Loop

Play every loop from here on the same way: set it up, play the night across the districts you choose, and when it ends read the loop's resolution, then **Between Loops**.

Loop Setup

1. If a loop or the Prologue just ended, click **Clear Board** on the Control token. Every card the boxes laid out, and every token on those cards, leaves the table. Each investigator heals all damage and horror, removes all clues and resources from their cards and discards all resources, shuffles every card they own except permanent cards back into their deck, takes 5 resources and draws an opening hand of 5 cards (mulligan as normal).
2. Press **Place** on **The Square (Town Hall)** box. It lays out the Square's locations, the **Hours** (agenda deck, Hour I on top), the scenario reference card, the shared encounter deck, the Square's act deck (in the district row between the mythos area and the map) and, set aside, the Appointed's cards (the Appointed, The Appointed's Approach, its Whispers, and two story cards whose text this guide gives).
3. Apply every Knowledge entry on your Campaign Log that changes the Hours (for example, an Hour removed from the Hours deck is taken out now).
4. The Control token now shows **Hour I** and Dissonance at the **scar**: the number of loops completed so far, maximum **6** at three investigators (Reset Loop set both).
5. **Choose the districts** you mean to visit this loop. For each one, press **Place** on its box: its locations join the map unrevealed (except any its entry says are revealed), its act deck takes its own spot in the district row, and its encounter set and any Named enemy go face down just below the mythos area. Shuffle each district's encounter set into the encounter deck. Leave each Named enemy set aside unless its district's entry says otherwise. Set up each district's act deck as **The Districts** describes. You may also Place another district's box later in the loop, immediately before an investigator moves into it; no investigator can move into a district whose box is not placed.
6. **Part II onward:** shuffle the Appointed's Whispers into the encounter deck.
7. Put **The Appointed's Approach** into play faceup beside the Hours deck; its text is active for the whole loop. The Appointed begins **Unseen**, set aside. Each investigator begins at **The Square**. Each "At the start of each loop" ability (Anchor Point) resolves now.
8. Read The Square's entry in **The Districts** now. The first time you enter any other district in this loop, read its entry.
9. If your Campaign Log records *You refused the ticket*: the first time a **Lost Hour** is drawn this loop, cancel its revelation effect. The fair's clock stops for you, once. If it records *The true page reached the Press*: group limit once per loop, moving between

The Square and The Reading Room does not advance the Hourglass.

Salt on your tongue. Lanterns across the Square. A band tuning up. It is eleven o'clock, and you have been here before.

Do not read until the loop ends.

A loop ends the moment one of its endings happens. Before anything else, claim Victory for each Victory X location in play, revealed and with no clues on it (see **Victory**). Then check the endings **top to bottom** and read the first that happened. Then read the **district resolution** for each district whose box you placed this loop (see **The Districts**), and then **Between Loops**.

Resolution 2 – The Seam Tears (Dissonance reached the reset value)

You leaned on what you remembered until the night could feel the weight. Every clock in Ambergrove stops on the same wrong second. The sky does not fold this time. It splits, and you fall back through the gap to eleven o'clock, bleeding time.

- The loop ended in danger: each investigator's **+1 Year** for ending in the Noticed band or higher applies.
- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Torn**.
- If this is the **second or later** Torn loop, read this instead of the usual interlude story: *The town has learned your shape. Strangers at the fair stop mid-laugh when you pass, and do not know why.*
- Read the district resolutions, then proceed to **Between Loops**.

No Resolution – The Night Keeps You (every investigator was defeated)

The dark finishes what it started. For a long moment there is nothing: no Square, no bell, no salt. Then the lanterns are being lit again, and you are standing where you always stand, and your hands will not stop shaking.

- Each investigator gains the **+1 Year** for being defeated.
- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Taken**.
- If this is the **second or later** Taken loop, read this instead of the usual interlude story: *You have died in this town more times than you can hold in your head at once. Each of you keeps one of those deaths close, like a stone in a pocket, and it is heavier every time.*
- Read the district resolutions, then proceed to **Between Loops**.

Resolution 1 – The Appointed Hour (the Hourglass reached Hour IX)

The occultation completes on time, exactly as the almanac promised. Something reaches through the edgeless dark, and, again, does not finish reaching. The night folds along its old crease. Eleven o'clock. Salt. The lanterns.

- In your Campaign Log, mark this loop **Closed at the Hour**.
- If you recorded **at least one** new Knowledge entry this loop, add to the interlude story: *It is the first night that felt like progress. You hold on to that.* If you recorded **none**, add: *Another night spent. The town did not notice you at all, which is its own kind of warning.*
- Read the district resolutions, then proceed to **Between Loops**.

Between Loops

Run this after every reset, and once after the Prologue. First, if you have not already, click **Reset Loop** on the Control token; then click **Interlude** on it for steps 1 to 3.

1. **Age.** (Skip this step after the Prologue.) Each investigator adds their reset Years for the loop just ended (see **Years**) plus their Years pending. Apply any bracket change now; the first time an investigator reaches Weathered or a later bracket, choose their locked changes on the Interlude panel (their –skill and +skill buttons) before clicking **Age**, then tick the same choices on the Campaign Log. An investigator who reaches 18 Years ages out.
2. **Bank Memory.** Move all Memory on cards (including the cards of investigators defeated this loop) to banked Memory.
3. **Spend.** Spend banked Memory from the shared pool, as **Memory** describes: buy Recollections at their listed Memory cost, and upgrade cards (Memory equal to the new card's level), within each investigator's deckbuilding options. Upgraded cards replace their base versions. After spending, if banked Memory is above **18**, reduce it to 18.
4. **Record.** Update the scar (loops completed, maximum 6 at three investigators), the Knowledge Track, the Victory list and any choices on your Campaign Log.
5. **Check the Part.** If Part II has not begun, and your log now records **3 or more** surface Knowledge entries or you have completed **Loop 3**: Part II begins. Read **The Shape of the Hour**.
6. **Read** one interlude story: the Torn or Taken story from the loop's resolution if it applies; otherwise the story below that fits the loop just ended, with any sentence the loop's resolution adds. Then read **The Shape of the Hour** if Part II began at step 5, **Before the finale** the first time your log records The Way the Night Breaks, and any age story. On the Control token, click **Begin Next Loop**, then begin the next loop at **Loop Setup**.

After the Prologue and each of the first three loops. You wake at First Dark with the taste of salt and the certainty that you have done this before. The others feel it too. No one in Ambergrove will believe you.

The Shape of the Hour (when Part II begins). The town has begun to notice that you notice. Somewhere past the edge of the Square, something that has been waiting politely decides to stop waiting. From the next loop, each district's second objective opens, the Appointed's Whispers join the encounter deck, and the Named enter the night.

After the fourth loop and every later loop. The night is the same. You are not. You catch yourself counting the hours in your sleep, and waking at eleven before the bell. The town is exactly as young as it was the first time. Every morning that never comes, you are a little older than it.

Age stories. The first time any investigator reaches a new age bracket, read its story aloud as well.

- **Weathered** (5 Years): *In the glass of the Hall of Mirrors there is a line beside your mouth that was not there when you came. The reflection notices it before you do.*
- **Elder** (10 Years): *The Winding Stair has more steps than it used to. It does not. You count them every loop, and every loop it takes you longer to reach the top.*
- **Ancient** (15 Years): *A child in the Square takes your hand to help you down the Town Hall steps. You have known this child for a hundred nights. To them you are a kind old stranger, and always will be.*
- If an investigator **ages out** (18 Years): *They do not wake at First Dark. You find them on the Sunken Road, walking in the same direction as the others, hood up. They do not turn when you call their name.*

Before the finale (once your log records The Way the Night Breaks). You know the shape of the night now. You know what it costs to end it. The only question left is who pays. You may attempt **The Last Hour** during any loop from now on, or keep looping to prepare, knowing each loop costs years.

The Districts

Read a district's entry the first time you enter it in a loop (The Square's during Loop Setup). Its objectives are printed on its act deck: act 1a (a surface objective) can be completed in either part, act 2a (a deep objective) only in Part II. When an act tells you to record something in your Campaign Log, do so at once. It lasts through every reset.

A district's act deck. Each placed district has its own current act, in its own spot; the Prologue and the finale use the act spot on the mythos mat. When you Place a district's box:

- If your Campaign Log records its deep (act 2a) entry, remove its act deck from the game: its objectives are complete.
- Otherwise, if your log records its surface (act 1a) entry: in Part I, remove the act deck from the game. In Part II, remove act 1a from the game; then, if act 2a's requirements are met, act 2a becomes the district's current act (resolve its "When this act becomes the current act" ability now); if they are not, remove the act deck from the game.
- Otherwise, act 1a is the district's current act.

If act 1a would advance to an act 2a whose requirements are not met, remove the act deck from the game instead.

District resolutions. When a loop ends, after its loop resolution, read one resolution for **each district whose box you placed this loop** (always including The Square). Check each district's resolutions **top to bottom** and read the first that applies. They tell what the night did with what you found there; anything they describe was already recorded on the act's back when you completed it, so they add nothing further to the log unless they say so.

Choices. The first time you complete a district's deep objective, its resolution asks the investigators to decide between two courses. Record the choice in your Campaign Log (**Choices**). Every choice echoes somewhere else in Ambergrove, and every one of them is waiting for you in **The Last Hour**.

The Lighthouse

The lamp at the end of the Sunken Road is dark. It has never, in any loop, been lit, and the keeper cannot remember why he didn't light it. The stair winds up into the smell of old oil and older salt.

If your Campaign Log already records The Lamp Was Never Lit, read this instead:

The beam you lit last time is gone, as if it had never been. The wick is dry again, the glass is cold, and the stair has forgotten your footsteps. But your hands have not forgotten the way up.

If your Campaign Log records The walkers keep their ring, add the following. This loop, after an investigator lights the lamp, exhaust each Echo in the Sunken Road district.

Far below, on the Sunken Road, the walkers have stopped. Every hood is turned toward the tower, waiting, as though someone once promised them a light.

When you Place this box: The Lantern Room (revealed), The Winding Stair and The Keeper's Quarters join the map. Shuffle its encounter set (The Dark That Waits, Something on the Stair) into the encounter deck. Its act deck: **Light the Lamp** (1a) and **The Ninth Death** (2a).

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Ninth Line (you completed The Ninth Death this loop)

You carry the logbook down with you, though you know it will be back on its shelf at eleven o'clock. Eight deaths, each dated tonight, each in the same careful hand. The ninth line is ruled and waiting. Whoever keeps this light has been dying for it a long time, and has been writing it down so that someone, someday, would read it.

- If **Elias Warde** is one of your investigators, add: *Elias does not speak on the walk back. At the Square he stops, and says, to no one, "Eight. I thought it was more." Then he goes on.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Sign the ninth line.** One investigator writes their own name on the waiting line, so that whoever keeps this light next is someone who chose it. The book takes its due at once: that investigator gains **1 Year** (click **Years pending** on their card). Record in your Campaign Log: *<that investigator> signed the ninth line.* (on the log token: this row's **1st** box.)
 - **Leave it blank.** Nobody else will be written into this book. Record in your Campaign Log: *The ninth line was left blank.* (on the log token: this row's **2nd** box.)

Resolution 2 – A Light on the Water (you completed Light the Lamp this loop)

For the rest of the night the beam swept the water, and the town below seemed to hold its breath beneath it. Then the night folded, and the light went out with everything else. It does not matter. You have done it once. The lamp will remember being lit, the way a door remembers being opened.

- If **Elias Warde** is one of your investigators, add: *Elias kept his hand on the lamp's brass until the last second. He still cannot remember why he left it dark. He is beginning to suspect that he was never given the chance.*

Resolution 3 – The Keeper's Round (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

You climbed the stair again, and the stair was the same. There is a kind of comfort in it now: the same smell of oil, the same cold glass, the same dark water. Whatever the Lighthouse still has to tell you, it will keep until you come back for it.

No Resolution – The Dark Keeps Its Lamp (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You never reached the light. From the road, looking back, the tower stands against the wrong sky like a finger raised for silence. Somewhere at the top of it, you are sure, something is waiting to be lit.

The Drowned Church

The bell tolled thirteen times at the first occultation. It should toll twelve. Water stands in the nave to the height of the pews, and the congregation is still kneeling in it.

If your Campaign Log already records The Thirteenth Toll, read this instead:

You count the strokes before they come. Twelve, and the pause, and the thirteenth. The congregation kneels in the black water exactly where it knelt before. None of them look up. The register in the Vestry has closed itself again.

If your Campaign Log records You have spoken the name, add:

The kneeling congregation is murmuring now, all of them, the same two syllables over and over under the black water. You know the word. You were the one who said it first.

When you Place this box: The Nave, The Belfry, The Vestry and The Flooded Crypt join the map. The Flooded Crypt enters play closed; it opens when **The Hour Was Wrong** becomes the current act, and enters play open (revealed) in every loop once your Campaign Log records The Hour Was Wrong. Shuffle its encounter set (The Drowned Choir, Thirteen, Rising Water) into the encounter deck. Its act deck: **Why Thirteen?** (1a) and **The Hour Was Wrong** (2a). **Part II:** its Named enemy stays set aside until its act spawns it.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Page Beneath the Water (you completed The Hour Was Wrong this loop)

You come up out of the crypt with the page held flat against your chest, water running out of your sleeves. One hour. The whole night hangs on one misprinted hour. When the loop folds, you feel it fold differently, as though a pleat in the night has been pressed out and will not come back.

- If you defeated **The Bell-Ringer Beneath** this loop, add: *Below the flooded steps the rope hangs slack. For the rest of the night, and only for the rest of the night, the bell did not ring at all.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine stood in the nave with her palm against the cold stone until the water rose. "I heard it," she says afterward. "The first time. I heard it strike thirteen, and I reached for it."*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Carry the page to the Press.** Where the wrong hour was set, the right one can be set again. Record in your Campaign Log: *The true page reached the Press.* (on the log token: this row's **1st** box.)
 - **Read it to the drowned.** They have knelt in the water all night waiting for someone to tell them the hour. Record in your Campaign Log: *The drowned heard the true hour.* (on the log token: this row's **2nd** box.)

Resolution 2 – Twelve Strokes and One (you completed **Why Thirteen?** this loop)

You close the register on the torn thirteenth stroke. Someone in this church knew the bell had rung wrong, and pressed so hard the nib went through. When the bell tolls the next hour, you listen to the thirteenth ring with new ears. It is not an echo. It is a count that does not end.

- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine does not look at the belfry for the rest of the night. When you ask why, she says only that she has heard that bell before, and not in this town.*

Resolution 3 – Kneeling Water (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The church kept its secrets tonight, and kept its congregation, kneeling and patient in the black water. You know more of it than they do. It is less comforting than it should be.

- If you defeated **The Bell-Ringer Beneath** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

No Resolution – Thirteen (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You leave with the bell still counting behind you. Twelve. Thirteen. You do not remember the moment you started counting along with it, under your breath, like a prayer you were taught as a child.

The Sunken Road

The road between the town and the shore. The same figures walk it every loop, in the same direction, hoods up, never arriving. Some of them turn to look at you now.

If your Campaign Log already records The Road Remembers, read this instead:

The walkers are already on the road when you reach it, as they always are, going the way they always go. You know the milestones by heart now, counting up toward the shore and down toward the town. One of the hooded figures slows, just slightly, as you pass.

If your Campaign Log records that an investigator signed the ninth line, add:

One of the walkers carries a book under their arm, bound in oilcloth like the keeper's log. As you pass, they turn it so you can see the spine. There is fresh ink on it.

When you Place this box: The Milestones, The Low Bridge and The Turning join the map. Shuffle its encounter set (The Waiting Congregation, The Bridge Remembers) into the encounter deck. Its act deck: **Walk It Backward** (1a) and **Who Walks Beside You** (2a).

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Worn Smooth (you completed Who Walks Beside You this loop)

You cannot stop seeing the face beneath the hood, worn smooth as a step, and the ring on the hand that rose to stop you. When the night folds you look for them in the crowd at the Square, and do not find them. They are on the road. They are always on the road. You wonder, for the first time, how many loops it takes to wear a face away.

- If **"Birdie" Okonkwo** is one of your investigators, add: *Birdie's compass swung toward the walker and held there, steady as north, until the night ended. She has not put it away since.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Take the ring.** The walker opens their hand and lets it go, as if it had been waiting a long time to be carried somewhere else. Record in your Campaign Log: *You carry the walker's ring.* (on the log token: this row's 1st box.)
 - **Leave it with them.** It is the last thing they have that is theirs. Record in your Campaign Log: *The walkers keep their ring.* (on the log token: this row's 2nd box.)

Resolution 2 – Against the Walkers (you completed Walk It Backward this loop)

You walked the road backward, and the road let you. The walkers did not stop you; some of them, you are almost sure, stepped aside. Whatever this road is, it has learned your shape, and you have learned its. You will not lose an hour on it again.

- If **"Birdie" Okonkwo** is one of your investigators, add: *"I came in on this road," Birdie says. "The wrong night. I remember the milestones counting down." No one asks her what they were counting down to.*

Resolution 3 – Same Direction (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The walkers went the way they always go, and so did the night. You watched them from the milestones for a while. None of them arrived. None of them ever will, unless someone changes the road.

No Resolution – Hoods Up (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You never learned where the walkers are going. At the end of the night they were still walking, and so, you realize as the night folds, were you: the same direction, hood of darkness up, not quite arriving.

The Square

The hub of the night. The sheriff stands on the Town Hall steps giving the same speech to the same crowd. He has been dead since ten o'clock. No one has noticed but you.

If your Campaign Log already records The Sheriff Is Already Dead, read this instead:

The sheriff clears his throat on the Town Hall steps and begins the speech you know by heart. You mouth the words along with him. Down in the Well, you know exactly what he is. The crowd applauds on cue.

If your Campaign Log records The town was warned, add:

Near the back of the crowd a woman in a green shawl is not watching the sheriff. She is watching you, frowning, the way you frown at a word on the tip of your tongue.

Every loop: the Square's box is placed in Loop Setup, so its locations (The Square and The Town Hall Steps revealed), encounter set (The Same Speech, The Crowd Turns) and act deck are always in play. Its act deck: **The Sheriff Is Already Dead** (1a) and **The Vote That Never Ends** (2a). **Part II:** its Named enemy stays set aside until its act spawns it.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Carried, Unanimous (you completed The Vote That Never Ends this loop)

Every name in Ambergrove, each in its own hand. You have walked past these people a hundred times: the baker, the band, the children on their fathers' shoulders. They signed. They wanted the door open, and they agreed to a price, and then they forgot. The applause for the sheriff's speech sounds different to you now. It sounds like a vote being taken again.

- If you defeated **What Wears the Sheriff** this loop, add: *It did not fall like a man. It folded, and for a moment the Town Hall steps were empty. Then the speech began again, from a mouth that was only a sheriff's.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine ran a finger down every name in the ledger. Hers is not there. She is not relieved.*
- If your Campaign Log records *The town was warned*, add: *One name near the bottom has been struck through, fresh, the ink still wet. Somebody listened to you, once, and took their name back.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Tear out the page.** No debt the town cannot remember agreeing to should be collected. Record in your Campaign Log: *The vote was torn out.* (on the log token: this row's **1st** box.)
 - **Leave the vote standing.** A promise, however foolish, is how this began. It may be how it ends. Record in your Campaign Log: *The vote still stands.* (on the log token: this row's **2nd** box.)

Resolution 2 – The Body in the Well (you completed The Sheriff Is Already Dead this loop)

You looked down the Well and saw him, and then looked up at the steps and saw him again, giving his speech to the lanterns. The town is not just repeating. Something is wearing it, the way a hand wears a glove. You spend the rest of the night studying faces and trying not to wonder which of them are still their own.

Resolution 3 – The Same Speech (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The speech ended the way it always ends. The crowd cheered the way it always cheers. You stood at the back and knew what they did not, and the knowing sat in you like a stone.

- If you defeated **What Wears the Sheriff** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

No Resolution – Eleven O'Clock (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

The lanterns, the band, the sheriff on the steps. You passed through the Square as everyone passes through it tonight, and it let you go. At the end of the night you are back in it, as you always will be, until you learn what it is hiding.

The Fairground

The occultation fair, mid-celebration, forever. The wheel turns. The music never finishes its tune. The ticket-taker smiles at you like he has been expecting you for a very long time.

If your Campaign Log already records The Wheel Still Turns, read this instead:

The music starts the same bar it started last time and gets no further. The wheel is turning. You know how the town looks from the top of it now, and you know how still it is. The ticket-taker lifts his hat to you, as he always does, as if you were old friends.

If your Campaign Log records You kept the night to yourselves, add:

The ticket-taker catches your eye across the crowd and touches one finger to the side of his nose. A man who keeps a secret knows another who does.

When you Place this box: The Wheel, The Hall of Mirrors and The Ticket Booth join the map. Shuffle its encounter set (The Wheel's Turn, Your Reflection Lies) into the encounter deck. Its act deck: **The Wheel Still Turns** (1a) and **The Ticket-Taker's Bargain** (2a). **Part II:** shuffle its Named enemy into the encounter deck with its encounter set; it spawns at **The Wheel** when drawn.

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – The Fare (you completed The Ticket-Taker's Bargain this loop)

He named no price. He only told you there was one, and that you would know it when you could afford it. As the night folds you can still hear the fair music playing its one unfinished bar, and under it, very softly, the punch of a ticket.

- If you defeated **The One Who Rides Forever** this loop, add: *The wheel stopped for the first time in a hundred years. It started again at eleven o'clock, as though nothing had happened. Something had.*
- If **Cass Lindqvist** is one of your investigators, add: *He called Cass by name and asked after her debts. Cass has never told anyone in Ambergrove about her debts. She spends the rest of the night working out the odds on how he knew, and does not like any of them.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Take the ticket.** He holds it out between two fingers. It is warm, and blank, and it is yours. Record in your Campaign Log: *You hold the ticket.* (on the log token: this row's **1st** box.)
 - **Refuse it.** Whatever he is selling, you will find another way out. Record in your Campaign Log: *You refused the ticket.* (on the log token: this row's **2nd** box.)

Resolution 2 – The Whole Town at Once (you completed The Wheel Still Turns this loop)

From the top of the wheel you saw Ambergrove laid out like a hand of cards face up on the table: every street full, no one moving, the church, the road, the dark tower at the end of it. Some part of you has kept that view. You find you can call it up with your eyes closed.

- If **Cass Lindqvist** is one of your investigators, add: *Cass counted the town from up there the way she counts a deck. "Somebody's dealing," she says afterward. "I just can't see the hand."*

Resolution 3 – One More Ride (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The fair went on without you, as it always does, and the tune got no further than it ever gets. The ticket-taker watched you leave. He did not seem disappointed. He seems to have all the time in the world.

- If you defeated **The One Who Rides Forever** this loop, read Resolution 1's first add-on instead of this resolution's story.

No Resolution – The Tune That Doesn't End (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

Lights, music, the wheel going round. You walked through the fair and it walked through you, and when the night folded you could still hear the tune, stopping, as it always stops, one note short of the end.

The Almanac House

Where the wrong almanac was printed. Stacks of it still wait by the press, bound and dated, the hour of the occultation set in fresh black type. At the back, a study door that no key in Ambergrove fits.

If your Campaign Log already records What the Almanac Hid, read this instead:

The press has set the wrong hour again overnight, as if you had never touched it. The stacks are bound and waiting. But the study door at the back is not as closed as it was. You can feel it, the way you feel someone behind you in an empty room.

If your Campaign Log records The true page reached the Press, add the following (its rule is in Loop Setup, step 9).

The page you brought up out of the flooded crypt lies on the bed of the press, dry now, and the type beside it has been set in the right order. Someone has been working here in the loops you were not watching.

When you Place this box: The Reading Room, The Press and The Sealed Study join the map. The Sealed Study enters play closed; it opens when **The Appointed's Name** becomes the current act, and enters play open (revealed) in every loop once your Campaign Log records The Appointed's Name. Shuffle its encounter set (The Page That Wasn't, Ink Runs Backward, The Study Door) into the encounter deck. Its act deck: **What the Almanac Hid** (1a) and **The Appointed's Name** (2a).

Do not read until the loop ends.

Resolution 1 – Written Once (you completed The Appointed's Name this loop)

You did not say it aloud. None of you did. But you carried it out of the Study all the same, and the night felt you carry it. For the rest of the loop the thing on the hill came on more slowly, like a guest who has heard their name called from inside the house and is no longer sure of their welcome.

- If **Dr. Ayako Sōma** is one of your investigators, add: *Ayako knows the language it is written in. She has spent her life trying to find someone who spoke it. She has found them.*
- If **Seraphine Vale** is one of your investigators, add: *Seraphine knows the name. She heard it once before, on the night she reached for the sky and something, very politely, reached back.*
- **The investigators must decide** (choose one):
 - **Speak the name.** Once, aloud, into the empty study, so that it knows you know. The night takes its price for that at once: each investigator gains **1 Year** (click **Years pending** on each investigator card). Record in your Campaign Log: *You have spoken the name.* (on the log token: this row's **1st** box.)
 - **Keep it unspoken.** A name held back is a name you can still use. Record in your Campaign Log: *The name is kept unspoken.* (on the log token: this row's **2nd** box.)

Resolution 2 – The True Hour (you completed What the Almanac Hid this loop)

For the rest of the night the reprinted pages lay warm on the press, printed with the right hour, and the sky above the Almanac House was almost ordinary. Almost. When the night folds, the press will set the wrong hour again. But you know now that the hour was wrong, and that somebody chose it.

- If **Dr. Ayako Sōma** is one of your investigators, add: *In the margin of the reprint, in a hand she recognizes as her own, is a translation note Ayako does not remember writing. It is one word. The word is "wait."*

Resolution 3 – Fresh Black Type (you completed no act here this loop, and your Campaign Log records at least one of this district's Knowledge entries)

The stacks were bound and dated. The press was set. You read what you could and left the rest, and at the back of the house the study door stayed exactly as closed as it chose to be.

No Resolution – Bound and Dated (your Campaign Log records none of this district's Knowledge entries)

You leave the Almanac House with ink on your fingers and nothing in your hands. The stacks go on waiting by the press, bound and dated for tonight, the hour of the occultation set in fresh black type. Someone printed that hour. Someone wanted it believed.

Finale – The Last Hour

Only once your Campaign Log records The Way the Night Breaks. During any loop from then on, an investigator at **The Sealed Study** may begin the finale as a ⚡ ability during their turn. Or, when Hour IX is reached while your log records *The Way the Night Breaks*, you may begin the finale instead of ending the loop.

Before the finale begins: if you completed a district's act 2a this loop, read that district's Resolution 1 now and make its choice (any Years it gives are gained now: click **Years pending**). Then read:

You have lived this night more times than you can hold. You know the toll, the road, the wrong sky, the name. You know what the town agreed to: an appointment made in ink and never kept.

You feel the loops in your body now. In the joints of your hands, in the grey at your temples, in the way the stair at the lighthouse has grown longer every time you climbed it. The town has not aged a single night. You have aged all of them.

Out on the hill, the guest has stopped being polite. All that is left is to keep the appointment, and to decide what you are willing to spend.

Setup

1. Press **Place** on **The Last Hour** box. **Contest the Crossing** becomes the current act, in the act spot on the mythos mat. Set every district's act deck aside: no district objective can be completed during the finale. Its set-aside stack goes to the mythos area's lower corner; do not read those cards.
2. Advance the Appointed's Approach to **Arrived** (click **Appointed** on the Control token until it shows Arrived). If it is set aside, it manifests. Dissonance keeps its current value. If the finale began at Hour IX, return Hours V to IX to the Hours deck in order, Hour V as the current agenda (no Hour resolves; right-click **Hour** four times); Hours VI to VIII resolve again when they are reached.
3. On the Control token, set **Contest** to 0. Then apply each of these your Campaign Log records:
 - *You have spoken the name*: gain 2 contest progress. It already knows that you know.
 - *The drowned heard the true hour*: rewind the Hourglass by 1 Hour. Below the church, a congregation is keeping time for you.

Contest progress. Gain 1 contest progress:

- each time an investigator succeeds at Hold Back;
- the first time each investigator is at The Sealed Study during the finale (an investigator already there when the finale begins gains it at once);
- each time a deep Knowledge entry is spent with the ➡ on Contest the Crossing. Each entry can be spent once per finale. Note it on the Finale Record; it stays recorded for every other purpose, including the resolutions.

When contest progress reaches **4 per investigator** (12 at three investigators), advance Contest the Crossing: the contest is reached. The finale also ends, with the contest **not** reached, when

Hour IX is reached, when every investigator has been defeated, or when Dissonance reaches the reset value.

During the finale, if your log records:

- *You carry the walker's ring*: once during the finale, when an investigator takes the Hold Back action, they may resolve it without a skill test: push the Appointed back one stage, disengage and exhaust it, and rewind the Hourglass by 1 Hour. This counts as succeeding at Hold Back.
- *The name is kept unspoken*: once during the finale, when the Hourglass would advance for any reason, the investigators may speak the name to cancel that entire advance (remove all doom from the current Hour).

Halfway. The first time your contest progress reaches half its target, read aloud: *Every clock in Ambergrove stops, then starts again, ticking backward. For one breath you are all the ages you have ever been at once: young and tired and old, standing on every step of every stair you ever climbed in this town. Then the moment passes, and the thing on the hill is closer, and so is the dawn.*

Do not read until the end of the finale.

An investigator is **present** if they took part in the finale and were not defeated during it. Years gained from a finale resolution never make an investigator age out, except where Resolution 4 says so.

When the finale ends, find where you stand:

- **If the contest was reached**, the night can be ended. **The investigators must decide how.** Choose **one** of Resolutions 1, 1b, 2, 3 or 4 whose condition you meet and read it. Resolution 4 is always available.
- **If the contest was not reached**, read Resolution 5 if banked Memory is at least 4 per investigator (12 at three investigators); otherwise read Resolution 6.

Then read **Epilogue — What the Years Took**.

Resolution 1 – Take Its Place (contest reached, and an Ancient investigator, or the investigator who signed the ninth line, is present)

Someone has to hold the night's crease closed from the inside. The one who has spent the most of themselves here knows it before anyone speaks. They take the lamp, or the pen, or simply each of your hands in turn, and they walk out onto the hill to meet the guest, and they do not come back down.

- The investigators choose one present investigator who is Ancient or who signed the ninth line. That investigator becomes the night's new anchor: kept behind, decades older, so that the loop ends for everyone else. Mark them **kept as anchor** on your Campaign Log.
- If your log records **Who Walks Beside You**, instead: the ones who walk the Sunken Road come up the hill and take the anchor's weight with you. At dawn the anchor walks out with the others, free and not kept, but **3 Years** older. If your log also records *The walkers keep their ring*, the walkers carry the anchor almost the whole way: **1 Year** older instead of 3.
- The town wakes for the first time in a hundred years. The campaign is over.

Resolution 1b – Let It In, On Your Terms (contest reached, your log records The Ticket-Taker's Bargain and You hold the ticket, and banked Memory is at least 4 per investigator, or 3 per investigator if you kept the night to yourselves)

He punches your ticket without looking. He has been expecting you for a very long time. The door opens, not the way the town opened it, begging, but the way you open a door to a guest you have decided to receive. It comes in. It sits down at the edge of the Square in the lantern light, and it is smaller than you feared, and it is very, very old.

- The door opens on your terms, not the town's, and the night finally ends.
- The fare is everything you carried: banked Memory drops to **0**, and each present investigator gains **2 Years**.
- Ambergrove wakes to a morning with one more guest in it. The campaign is over.

Resolution 2 – Close the Door (contest reached, your log records The Vote That Never Ends, The Appointed's Name and The vote still stands)

You pay the price the town agreed to and never paid. It is paid in years, as every price here is. You feel them go, all at once, like stepping off a stair that is not there. When you look up the sky has an edge again, and the edge is the dawn.

- Each present investigator gains **3 Years** at once, and the door closes. If your log records *The town was warned*, Ambergrove remembers just enough to share the cost: **2 Years** each instead.
- The cleanest true ending, bought with years. The campaign is over.

Resolution 3 – Break Through (contest reached, and your log records The Keeper's Ninth Death)

You force the night open, and every present investigator runs through before it can close. Behind you the Square, the band, the lanterns, the sheriff on his steps, all fold away like a stage set in the rain.

- Every present investigator escapes. The campaign is over.
- But the loop is only paused. Somewhere, some night, an almanac will be printed with the wrong hour again. Was it really ended?
- If your log records *The ninth line was left blank*, read this instead of the last point: *No one is written into the keeper's book. No one is owed. The loop has nothing left to hold, and it does not start again.*

Resolution 4 – Seal by Force (contest reached)

The door is sealed, but not closed. Someone has to lean against it until the dawn comes, and the dawn is a long way off.

- The investigators choose one present investigator. They age out holding the door shut. The campaign is over.
- If your log records *The vote was torn out*, no debt is owed behind that door, and it pushes back with nothing but its own weight. The chosen investigator holds it until morning and walks away **3 Years** older instead of aging out.

Resolution 5 – Next Time (contest not reached, banked Memory at least 4 per investigator)

The loop wins tonight. The guest keeps its appointment, and the night folds along its old crease. But you have carried so much of it now that the fold does not quite close over you. You wake at First Dark closer than ever, older than ever, and certain.

- The loop ends. Mark it **Closed at the Hour** and proceed to **Between Loops**. You may attempt the finale again.
- Do not read the epilogue yet.

Resolution 6 – The Loop Wins (contest not reached, banked Memory below 4 per investigator)

The night takes you. The town keeps repeating, and somewhere on the Sunken Road, walking the same direction and never arriving, there are new faces beneath the hoods.

- The campaign ends. Do not read the epilogue.

Epilogue — What the Years Took. Unless you read Resolution 5 or 6, read one line for each investigator who is present at the end, was not kept as anchor and did not age out, matching their age bracket after the resolution's Years.

- **Prime:** *You leave Ambergrove as young as you came, and no one on the train believes how tired you are.*
- **Weathered:** *There is grey in your hair that was not there the night you arrived. You keep it. It is the only proof.*
- **Elder:** *Your hands shake a little now in the mornings. You spent years on one night, and you would spend them again.*
- **Ancient:** *The station master helps you down from the carriage and asks if you have family meeting you. You had family, once, a hundred years ago tonight.*
- An investigator **kept as anchor** has no epilogue. On clear nights in Ambergrove, the lamp at the end of the Sunken Road is lit.

Difficulty and Player Count

- **3 investigators:** every value as printed (Dissonance bands at 6 / 12, reset at 18, Memory cap 18, contest 12, scar cap 6).
- **2 or 4 investigators:** the reset comes at $6 \times \text{investigators}$; the Glitch band starts at one-third of the reset and the Noticed band at two-thirds ($4 \times \text{investigators}$). The Memory cap is $6 \times \text{investigators}$, the contest is $4 \times \text{investigators}$, and the scar cap is one-third of the reset.
- **1 investigator:** the reset comes at 9 and the Noticed band at 6; Glitch starts at 3. The Memory cap is 6, the contest 4, the scar cap 3.
- Values given "per investigator" (the finale's contest and Memory thresholds) scale on their own.
- The Control token applies all of these for you.
- The campaign is tuned for about 6–8 loops.

The Still Hour – Campaign Log

Fill in at each interlude. Everything on this sheet persists across resets.

Campaign started: _____ Difficulty: ☐ Easy ☐ Standard ☐ Hard ☐ Expert

Loop Counter

Completed loops

Scar next loop (= loops; max 3/4/6/8 at 1–4 inv.):

Investigators:

Current Part: ☐ I — Learning the Rules ☐ II — The Shape of the Hour ☐ The Last Hour available

Investigators

Investigator 1

Name _____

Class _____ Player _____

Years ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 • Weathered 5–9 • Elder 10–14 • Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ -1 ☐ -1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Recollections _____

☐ Aged out **Finale:** _____

Investigator 2

Name _____

Class _____ Player _____

Years ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 • Weathered 5–9 • Elder 10–14 • Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ -1 ☐ -1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Recollections _____

☐ Aged out **Finale:** _____

Investigator 3

Name _____

Class _____ Player _____

Years ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 • Weathered 5–9 • Elder 10–14 • Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ -1 ☐ -1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Recollections _____

☐ Aged out **Finale:** _____

Investigator 4

Name _____

Class _____ Player _____

Years ☐ Prime ☐ Weathered ☐ Elder ☐ Ancient
Prime 0–4 • Weathered 5–9 • Elder 10–14 • Ancient 15+

Drift ☐ -1 ☐ -1 ☐ +1 ☐ +1

Recollections _____

☐ Aged out **Finale:** _____

Banked Memory

Banked Memory (cap 6 × investigators: after spending, reduce to the cap)

Spent this interlude

Spent on: _____

Campaign notes

The Knowledge Track

When the guide says to record an entry, tick its row (or write its name on the line). It lasts through every reset.

☐ Prologue	_____
☐ Lighthouse — surface	_____
☐ Lighthouse — deep	_____
☐ Church — surface	_____
☐ Church — deep	_____
☐ Sunken Road — surface	_____
☐ Sunken Road — deep	_____
☐ Square — surface	_____
☐ Square — deep	_____
☐ Fairground — surface	_____
☐ Fairground — deep	_____
☐ Almanac — surface	_____
☐ Almanac — deep	_____
☐ Assembled	_____

Surface entries recorded:



/ 6 — Part II at 3+

Deep entries recorded:



/ 6

Victory

		claimed	Memory banked
Church — Named (Victory 2)	_____	☐	☐
Square — Named (Victory 3)	_____	☐	☐
Fairground — Named (Victory 2)	_____	☐	☐
The Keeper's Quarters	(Lighthouse, Victory 1)	☐	☐
The Flooded Crypt	(Church, Victory 1)	☐	☐
The Records Office	(Square, Victory 1)	☐	☐
The Ticket Booth	(Fairground, Victory 1)	☐	☐
The Sealed Study	(Almanac, Victory 1)	☐	☐

Threads

Seraphine's thread:

☐ unheard ☐ suspected ☐ known

Those Who Left the Loop

Investigator

Fate

Loop

_____	☐ aged out ☐ in the finale	_____
_____	☐ aged out ☐ in the finale	_____
_____	☐ aged out ☐ in the finale	_____
_____	☐ aged out ☐ in the finale	_____

Choices

Prologue ended: ☐ R1 ☐ R2 ☐ No Resolution

Loops ended: Torn

☐

Taken

☐

Closed at the Hour

☐

Prologue

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Lighthouse

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Drowned Church

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Sunken Road

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Square

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Fairground

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

The Almanac House

☐ 1st☐ 2nd

Name (Lighthouse):

Finale Record

Attempted on loop: _____

Contest reached: ☐ yes ☐ no

Banked Memory:

☐

Resolution reached:

☐ R1 ☐ R1b ☐ R2 ☐ R3 ☐ R4 ☐ R5 ☐ R6

Deep entries spent this finale:

How the night ended:

Years paid at the end:

Campaign Notes
